

Goal-Setting Worksheet

FREE RESOURCE · COACHING

Goal-Setting Worksheet

A structured goal-setting worksheet using the SMART framework, with reflection prompts for identifying obstacles, support needed, and accountability — plus a review and progress tracker.

SMART Framework

Obstacle Planning

Support & Accountability

Progress Tracker

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SMART elements

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obstacle prompts

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support prompts

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review checkpoints

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through the SMART framework first to shape a single, well-defined goal — resist the urge to write several goals at once. Then use the obstacle and support sections to pressure-test it before you commit. The tracker on the final page is designed to be revisited, not filled in once and filed away.

The SMART Framework

Work through each element in order. A goal that is Specific and Measurable but not Time-Bound tends to drift; one that is Achievable but not Relevant tends to lose your motivation halfway through.

S

Specific

Precise, not vague — a goal you could describe to a stranger in one clear sentence.

What exactly do you want to achieve? Who is involved, and where does this happen?

M Measurable

A way to know, concretely, whether you've achieved it — not just a feeling of progress.

How will you know you've succeeded? What number, milestone, or outcome will prove it?

A Achievable

Realistic given your current time, resources, and constraints — a stretch, not a fantasy.

Is this realistic right now? What would need to be true for this to be achievable?

R Relevant

Genuinely connected to what matters to you — not a goal you feel you should want.

Why does this matter to you right now? How does it connect to your bigger priorities?

T Time-Bound

A real deadline — goals without a date tend to quietly drift indefinitely.

What is your target date? What are the milestone dates along the way?

YOUR FULL GOAL STATEMENT

Now combine all five elements into a single sentence you could say out loud to someone else.

Obstacle Identification

Most goals fail not because the goal was wrong, but because a foreseeable obstacle wasn't planned for in advance. This section exists to make those obstacles visible now.

What could get in the way internally — habits, mindset, or skill gaps?

Think about what has derailed similar goals for you before. Old patterns are often the most reliable predictor.

What could get in the way externally — resources, other people, or competing priorities?

Name specific people, deadlines, or constraints — not just "lack of time" in the abstract.

Which of these obstacles is most likely to actually derail you, and why?

Be honest here. The obstacle you're tempted to downplay is usually the one that matters most.

What's your specific plan if that obstacle shows up?

Decide this now, while you're clear-headed — not in the moment when the obstacle actually appears.

Support & Accountability

Goals pursued in isolation are far more likely to stall. This section makes explicit who else is involved in helping you succeed.

Who can support you in achieving this goal, and how specifically?

Name the person and the specific kind of support — advice, encouragement, resources, or simply checking in.

Who will hold you accountable, and how often will you check in with them?

A goal with no external accountability relies entirely on willpower, which is the least reliable option available.

What resources, tools, or training do you need that you don't already have?

Naming a gap now is more useful than discovering it three weeks into pursuing the goal.

How will you mark progress or celebrate completion?

Decide this in advance — goals that end without any acknowledgement are harder to sustain motivation for next time.

Review & Progress Tracker

Schedule your first check-in before you close this document. A goal reviewed on a fixed cadence is far more likely to be achieved than one revisited only when things go wrong.

Review Date	Progress Update	On Track? (Y/N)	Adjustments Needed

A NOTE ON ADJUSTING THE GOAL

Revising a goal partway through is not failure — it's often a sign the goal is being taken seriously enough to test against reality. If you adjust it, update the SMART framework on the earlier pages rather than abandoning the structure altogether.